



Rating

Buy

North America
United States

TMT

IT Hardware and Supply Chain

Company

HPE

Reuters
HPE.N

Bloomberg
HPE US

Date

1 October 2026

Rating	Buy
Price target (USD)	68.00
Price at 30 Sep 26	63.89
52-week range	63.89 – 20.00

[Valuation & Risks](#)

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Networking investor day: shows up with receipts

Networking guidance raised, cost synergies updated

HPE hosted its 2026 Networking Investor Day today in Sunnyvale, led by Rami Rahim (the former CEO of Juniper Networks, and current EVP and General Manager of HPE Networking). Management raised its FY27 outlook for the networking segment to high teens to low 20% revenue growth, with margins remaining strong in the mid to high 20% range through FY29. Management also raised the Juniper cost synergy target from \$600 million to \$800 million. The broader plan is to leverage Juniper acquisition to create an end-to-end networking platform and drive growth through cross selling, higher services attachment, and integrated AI infrastructure.

First commercial win for Helios, TP unchanged, reiterated buy

HPE also announced its first commercial order for AMD's Helios AI rack platform, a \$1.2B deal with Vultr using HPE's new Juniper QFX5252 scale-up switch. This is the first real customer win anywhere in the Helios ecosystem, beating competitors to market by several months. Worth noting, the switch runs on an open standard called UALink, backed by a wide range of semiconductor and technology companies as an alternative to Nvidia's proprietary NVLink. This move toward open standards is a big win for the broader ecosystem because it gives customers much more flexibility when building out their data centers. HPE's real advantage here is its ability to deliver the entire package, which includes compute, networking, cooling, and services under one roof. This is something that pure play chip or switch makers struggle to match. Now, Vultr itself points to a broader opportunity in the neocloud space, the newer wave of GPU focused cloud providers. Unlike the big hyperscalers, most neoclouds don't have the in house engineering to design and integrate their own racks so they'd rather just buy the whole thing from a vendor like HPE. We reiterate a Buy rating with our PT unchanged since our 18.5% networking growth estimate already sits near the high end of the new guidance of approximately 20%. We also updated our EPS estimate, which is now 1% above our prior estimate.



Data Center networking, the number to watch

The standout number in the guidance was data center networking, which is expected to grow at a 3-year CAGR in the low to high 50% range from FY26 to FY29. While both endpoints of that timeline fully include Juniper, the FY26 baseline is a bit soft because the quarters still carry some noisy comparisons. In fact, Data Center Networking revenue actually slipped 6% on a normalized basis last quarter due to supply constraints that held back shipping, even though orders grew in the high double digits. To address this, management has already doubled its supply commitments and expects those constraints to ease in FY27.

What to watch now?

Competing switches for the Helios platform from other established players are expected later this year, so HPE's current lead is worth watching rather than assuming permanent. Today's presentation also only covered Networking, not Cloud and AI, where margins have been improving but still need one to two quarters to prove out. Our own take is that HPE will also need to keep investing in R&D to support these newer scale-up products, and that could mean the climb toward the higher end of the margin target takes a bit longer.

None of these changes our view. HPE has now raised and beaten its own guidance for three straight quarters, and today's event gave investors a clearer picture of how that momentum could carry through FY29. The Juniper integration appears to be working, the networking growth story is getting stronger, and HPE has more exposure to AI infrastructure spending than it did a year ago. The update was positive, though the next few quarters will need to show progress on easing supply constraints, converting backlog into revenue, executing on Helios, improving margins, and turning cross selling into lasting share gains.



Appendix 1

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Company	Ticker	Recent price	Disclosure
HPE	HPE.N	63.89 (USD) 30 Sep 26	1, 2, 7, 8, 14, 15, 21, 24, 26

Prices are current as of the end of the previous trading session unless otherwise indicated and are sourced from local exchanges via Reuters, Bloomberg and other vendors. Other information is sourced from Deutsche Bank, subject companies, and other sources.

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Historical recommendations and target price: HPE (HPE.N)



1.	19 Jan 24	Coverage suspended
2.	8 Oct 24	Price target: 22 (USD), close price 20.97 (USD), Recommendation: Hold, Analyst: Matthew Niknam
3.	10 Dec 24	Price target: 25 (USD), close price 21.92 (USD), Recommendation: Hold, Analyst: Matthew Niknam
4.	19 Dec 24	Price target: 25 (USD), close price 20.89 (USD), Recommendation: Buy, Analyst: Matthew Niknam
5.	7 Mar 25	Price target: 20 (USD), close price 15.81 (USD), Recommendation: Buy, Analyst: Matthew Niknam
6.	9 Jun 25	Price target: 21 (USD), close price 18.31 (USD), Recommendation: Buy, Analyst: Matthew Niknam
7.	22 Jul 25	Price target: 26 (USD), close price 20.41 (USD), Recommendation: Buy, Analyst: Matthew Niknam
8.	4 Aug 25	Coverage suspended
9.	31 Aug 26	Price target: 62 (USD), close price 52.24 (USD), Recommendation: Buy, Analyst: Gianmarco Conti
10.	3 Sep 26	Price target: 68 (USD), close price 54.44 (USD), Recommendation: Buy, Analyst: Gianmarco Conti



Company rating dispersion and banking relationships

DBSI Companies under Coverage	Buy	Hold	Sell
Covered	57%	42%	0%
w/ Banking relationship	43%	34%	0%
w/ MiFID services	64%	52%	67%

Global Companies under Coverage	Buy	Hold	Sell
Covered	58%	40%	2%
w/ Banking relationship	46%	32%	26%
w/ MiFID services	75%	67%	90%

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Note - percentages are rounded so may not total 100%.

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